

MBTMY

MBTMY Vibathon 2026 #BEYOND THE VIBE



AI Defined Vehicle

What is Vibathon?

Vibathon = Hackathon + Vibe Engineering

Vibathon is an annual hackathon event under MBTMY's Tech Front Runner innovation program. It focuses on leveraging AI-driven development ("Vibe Engineering") to rapidly turn ideas into meaningful MVPs, fostering a strong culture of experimentation, collaboration, and continuous innovation while validating real-world business impact.



#WHEN CODE MEETS VIBE

What is Vibathon?

Vibathon 2026

In 2026, AI is no longer just for specialists, it is for everyone, on every device or machine.

From enterprise applications to intelligent, connected car experiences, AI has become a natural layer woven into everything we build and use.

This year, we are aiming for higher altitude, focusing not just on the vibe, but on what we can truly build and create.

Therefore, this year's Vibathon theme is...

#Beyond The Vibe



What is Vibathon?

Vibathon 2026 Categories

Academy



Open to students from



MBTM4



Open to employees in MBTM4

Mechanical Era

Connected Era

Software-Defined Era

AI-Defined Era



Evolution Of Automotive

Mechanical Power

Electronics & Connectivity

Centralized software & OTA

Autonomous and Self Learning

From mechanical muscle to digital intelligence, every automotive era writes a new chapter of innovation.

140 years of Innovation
Mercedes-Benz

What is AIDV?

Emerging as the next evolution of Software Defined Vehicle (SDVs), AIDVs use AI to personalize, predict, and adapt to surroundings, driver preferences, and passengers in real-time, focusing on human-centric design

Mercedes-Benz S-Class 2026/27

Intelligent Damper Control leverages cloud-based Car2X data from vehicles ahead to proactively adjust suspension damping and enhance ride comfort.



We never stop innovating

We would like to invite students to join us in innovating and reimagining the future potential of AI driven vehicles.

Challenge

Challenge: Build an AI-driven system where the vehicle or its connected ecosystem acts as an intelligent agent learning from data, adapting to situations, and proactively making real-time decisions.

Demonstrate how your ideation or Proof of Concept (PoC) enhances the experience **around the Car, Customer, or Mercedes.**

Your solution may focus on:

- **Intelligent Experience**
Elevate driving experience, user journeys through personalized in-car, off-car and digital experiences.
- **Dynamic Safety & Security**
Enhance driving safety, vehicle protection, and data privacy with AI.
- **Operational Efficiency**
Optimize vehicle performance, energy usage, and real-time decision-making.
- **Digital Extras & Upsell**
Enable smart feature-on-demand services and contextual in-car engagement.

Date	Activity	Details
14 May	MBTMY Open Day	On-site visit to Mercedes-Benz Tech Malaysia featuring office tour, career advisory, and sharing sessions on AI in SDLC and Automotive Software Development
15 May – 25 May	AIDV Vibathon26 Registration	Student registration period for Vibathon participation
25 May – 27 May	Shortlisting – Top 14 Teams	Top 14 finalist teams selected from based on the ideation, solution submitted
1 July	AIDV Vibathon26 AIDV Flag Off	Virtual kickoff session covering event briefing, hackathon scope, and event update.
2 – 3 July	Remote Technical Mentoring Sessions	Mentor and support session
6 July	AIDV Vibathon Pitching @ MBTMY L4 Summit, Wisma Mercedes Benz Malaysia	On-site pitching session where teams present their solutions to judges Each team is given 4 minutes to pitch and 4 minutes QnA from the judges
31 July	Vibathon26 Award Ceremony	Prize-award ceremony at MBTMY Strategy Workshop dinner

Pitch Day 6 July 2026

Date	Agenda
9.00 – 9.10	Opening and welcome Speech
9.10- 10.20	Pitching Session 1 (Teams 1-7)
10.20- 10.35	Break
10.35-11.45	Pitching Session 2 (Teams 8-14)
11.45-12.00	Judges Deliberation
12.00-13.00	Lunch
13.00-13.30	Result announcement

Location
Wisma Mercedes Benz
The Summit, Level 4, MBTMY
Taman Perindustrian, 16A, Jln BK 1/13, Bandar
Kinrara, 47180 Puchong, Selangor

How to participate?

Requirement:

Form a team of 4 with your university mate

How to participate:

1. Form a team with total of 4 members with your university mates.
2. Reach out to your student's representatives (Task Force Team) appointed by MBTMY.
3. Understand the Vibathon challenge, ground rules of the event.
4. Submit your registration form together with signed copy of participation consent form.
5. Optional: Learn how to develop in AAOS app recommend resources.
4. Join the virtual flag off to get the latest update.
5. Vibe your solutions, get mentors' support.
6. Pitch at the Summit, L4 MBTMY on 6 July 2026.

Registration Dateline: 15 May – 25 May 2026

Each team is allocated 4 minutes to pitch and 4 minutes QnA from the judges

4 Minutes

Problem Statement & Solution
Demonstration
Technical Overview
Impact & Future

4 Minutes

Question And Answer from
Judges

Prizes



Champion

Mercedes-Benz Merchandise worth up to
RM 1,000



Runner Up

Mercedes-Benz Merchandise worth up to
RM 800



**2nd Runner
Up**

Mercedes-Benz Merchandise worth up to
RM 600

* All shortlisted participants and winners will receive digital certificate of participation



Ken Wei Gan
HOD, MBTMY



Swee Yueng Fun
Car Stream Lead, MBTMY



Industry Expert
Mercedes-Benz Malaysia



Associate Prof. Dr. Norisma
Dean of FSKTM, University Malaya



Eddy Loh
Team Lead, MBTMY



Chua Ki Wei
Team Lead, MBTMY



Industry Expert
Mercedes-Benz Malaysia

Judging Criteria

The hackathon projects will be evaluated based on a balanced view of innovation, technical strength, and real-world impact. Judges will assess not only how well the solution is built, but also how meaningful and usable it is in the context of AI-powered vehicles.

Criteria	Description	Score
Innovation & Creativity	Originality and uniqueness of the idea	20%
AI Utilization	Effective and meaningful use of AI capabilities	20%
Impact & Value	Potential business, user, or societal impact	20%
User Experience	Usability, design, and overall interaction	15%
Technical Implementation	Quality, functionality, and technical feasibility	15%
Presentation & Demo	Clarity of pitching, storytelling, and demo quality	10%
		100%

Q. Can the university task force team members participate in the Vibathon?

A. Yes

Q. Any participation fee required from MBTMY?

A. No

Q. Do we need develop full system?

A. No. Deliver the best result for demonstration

Q. Can I pitch remotely?

A. No. Unable to present during the pitch day considered as disqualified

Q. Can I vibe it?

A. Yes. It is encouraged to do so, we see vibe coding speed up the prototyping

Q. Do you provide the vehicle data.

A. Mocked data will be provided.

Q. Can a non-registered participant join the pitching day?

A. No. It is by invitation only.

Q. The solution must be delivered as AAOS app?

A. No. Depends your solution, it can be mobile app, web application.

Q. Are only students from IT-related courses allowed to join the hackathon?

A. No, the hackathon is open to all students from Xiamen University and Sunway University, regardless of course or field of study.

Q. Can I submit multiple ideations?

A. No, each participant may only join one team and submit one ideation.

Q. Attending MBTMY Open Day is the requirement to participate Vibathon?

A. No, both are separate event.

Ground Rules

Eligibility (Internal & External)

The competition is open to all students from Xiamen University and Sunway University, including internal and external participants.

One Team, One Project Rule

Each participant may register with only one team and submit only one project throughout the competition.

Team Size

Each team must consist of exactly four (4) members.

Original Work

We strongly encourage original ideas and solutions.

Participants may leverage open-source libraries, frameworks, or tools, provided they comply with the applicable licenses and clearly acknowledge their use.

Submission & Pitching

All teams are required to present their projects physically on the designated pitching date, as stated in the event schedule.

Project Scope

Submitted projects must directly address the assigned theme or problem statement and remain within the defined scope of the competition.

Code Ownership & Intellectual Property

Refer to **Participation Consent and Intellectual Property Assignment Form**.

By participating, teams grant MBTMY the right to showcase, demonstrate, and use the projects for promotional, internal, and business development purposes.

Code of Conduct

All participants are expected to behave in a professional, respectful, and ethical manner throughout the competition, including during preparation, development, pitching, and all event-related interactions.

Participants must:

- Treat fellow participants, judges, mentors, organizers, and guests with respect and courtesy
- Foster an inclusive, harassment-free, and safe environment
- Communicate professionally in person and through any digital channels related to the event
- Properly acknowledge any open-source libraries, tools, datasets, or external resources used
- Present work honestly and refrain from misrepresentation of contributions or functionality

Harassment, discrimination, intimidation, plagiarism, cheating, falsification of work, or any form of unethical conduct will not be tolerated.

Disqualification

The organizers reserve the right to disqualify any team or participant at their sole discretion if they are found to:

- Violate any rule or guideline of the competition
- Breach the Code of Conduct
- Submit non-original, plagiarized, or misleading work
- Engage in disruptive, abusive, or inappropriate behavior
- Fail to comply with instructions from the organizers or judges

Disqualification decisions are final and may result in removal from the competition without prior notice.

AAOS Development:

Official Android Developers Resources

1.Android for Cars App Library

Learn the fundamentals of building apps for Android Auto and Android Automotive OS.

[Android for Cars App Library](#)

2.Set Up Your AAOS Project

Step-by-step guide to configure and start your first in-car app project.

[AAOS Project Setup Guide](#)

3.Design for Driving Guidelines

Learn automotive UX principles, templates, and driver distraction rules.

[Design for Driving](#)

4.Android for Cars Samples

Official sample projects and code examples for beginners.

[Android for Cars Samples](#)

AI Driven Engineering:

GitHub Student Developer Pack — Free access to developer tools, cloud credits, and AI tools.

[GitHub Student Developer Pack](#)

Free AI Design & Presentation Tools

Canva AI — Design presentations, posters, social media, and visuals.

[Canva](#)

Figma — Collaborative UI/UX design platform with free student-friendly tier.

[Figma](#)

Free AI Coding & Development Tools

GitHub Copilot for Students — Free AI coding assistant with verified student account.

[GitHub Education](#)

Free LLM / AI APIs

Google Gemini API — Generous free tier for AI apps, chatbots, multimodal, and coding.

[Google AI Studio](#)

OpenRouter — Access multiple free/open LLMs through a single API.

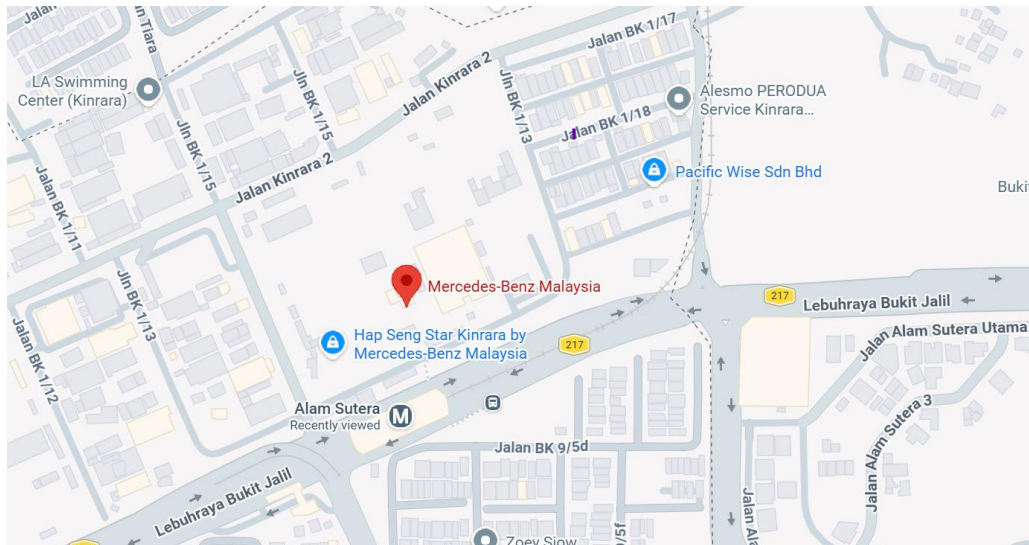
[OpenRouter](#)

Event Location



Wisma Mercedes Benz
Level 4, MBTMY

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Vibathon AIDV MBTMY Team

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